HEALTHCARE INTELLIGENCE · FROM PUBLIC SOURCES NO. 5

VIGILLINE DAILY

FRIDAY, 30 OCTOBER 2026 BENGALURU COMPETITIVE INTELLIGENCE

Vertex's kidney disease drug under infection-risk scrutiny before Nov 30 FDA decision

Vertex's kidney disease drug is being scrutinised for infection risk ahead of the FDA's approval decision on Nov 30, STAT News reported. The summary gives the date and the scrutiny, but no trial data or regulatory position.

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The summary gives the decision date and the subject of the scrutiny, and nothing else: no trial data, no comparator, no size of the treated population, no regulatory position. It is a pointer to the decision, not a verdict.

What is being scrutinised is infection risk. The summary does not quantify that risk, describe the mechanism, or compare it with the drug's benefits. Any verdict on the drug's prospects has to wait for the fuller record.

For competitive intelligence, the event to track is the FDA's decision on Nov 30 and the reasoning published with it. Until that lands, the summary fixes the date and the scrutiny, and nothing more.

IN NUMBERS

$285 million

value of Astellas's exclusive option on a preclinical IL-12 cancer asset from Audax Biosciences

$600 million

size of the fund Formation Bio has raised to acquire, develop and hand off assets

$350 million

amount Dren Bio has raised to take its lead blood cancer drug to market by the end of 2027

ALSO TODAY

Lilly's retatrutide shows greater A1C reduction and weight loss than Ozempic in Phase 3 trial
EXPRESS PHARMA

CPHI India & PMEC India 2026 to connect India's pharma value chain across ingredients, manufacturing and technology
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STAT+: HHS moves to allow compounding of some unapproved peptides
STAT NEWS

BRIEFS

FDA sets out the path for approving individually tailored gene editing therapies

The FDA has outlined steps drugmakers can take to seek regulatory approval for gene editing medicines tailored to fix a single person's disease-causing mutation, Endpoints News reported. The summary does not say what the announcement forms part of, or what regulatory framework it uses. It names neither the specific gene editing platform nor the conditions being targeted.

ENDPOINTS NEWS

Ono Pharma's endocannabinoid modulator fails five Phase 2 trials

Ono Pharma's endocannabinoid modulator ONO-1110 did not meet the primary endpoint in five separate Phase 2 studies, Endpoints News reported. The summary also covers layoffs at Lenz and Molecular Partners, plus news on GSK, Ascletis, BioMarin, Rigerna and Hisun. No trial details were available in the summary.

ENDPOINTS NEWS

Astellas takes exclusive option on preclinical IL-12 cancer asset

Astellas has taken an exclusive option to license a preclinical immuno-oncology asset from Australian biotech Audax Biosciences, Endpoints News reported. The deal features $285 million covering an upfront fee and a payment that becomes due if a stated condition is met. The summary names neither the asset nor the remaining milestones.

ENDPOINTS NEWS

Formation Bio raises $600 million for its acquire-and-hand-off model

Formation Bio, an AI-focused biotech that acquires outside assets, develops them and then hands them off, has raised a $600 million fund to double down on that strategy, Endpoints News reported. The summary gives no investors, term or asset count.

ENDPOINTS NEWS

Bristol Myers defends pipeline and later-stage deal interest

Bristol Myers Squibb is reemphasising its plan to stave off one of the industry's most daunting patent cliffs, Endpoints News reported. Speaking to analysts on its earnings call on Thursday, executives at the New Jersey pharma company touted the company's later-stage deal pipeline. The summary names no specific programmes or dates.

ENDPOINTS NEWS

Dren Bio raises $350 million to reach a blood cancer drug by 2027

Dren Bio has raised $350 million, hoping to get its lead blood cancer drug onto the market by the end of 2027, Endpoints News reported. The California drug developer told Endpoints News exclusively. The summary gives no detail on the drug, its stage or the trial plan.

ENDPOINTS NEWS

SOURCES

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Express Pharma — https://www.expresspharma.in/lillys-retatrutide-shows-greater-a1c-reduction-and-weight-loss-than-ozempic-in-phase-3-trial/
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